

THE SESSION • POST-CLOSE READ

Hike Signal, *Stocks* Pause

The S&P 500 slipped 0.23% as the Federal Reserve's September minutes showed most participants expect another rate increase by year-end and the 10-year Treasury yield rose to about 5.36% intraday before easing. Dividend Strategy -1.01% trailed DVY and SPY; Growth Portfolio -0.97% trailed IUSG.

S&P 500 ▼ 0.23% NASDAQ ▼ 0.22% DOW ▼ 0.66% VIX ▲ 0.47% BRENT ▲ \$101

DIVIDEND STRATEGY

▼ TRAILED DVY + SPY

-1.01%

1-DAY

FCI		-1.01%
DVY		-0.42%
SPY		-0.24%

YTD +17.14% vs DVY +11.20% • SPY +14.87%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO

▼ TRAILED IUSG

-0.97%

1-DAY

FCI		-0.97%
IUSG		-0.24%

YTD +24.73% vs IUSG +18.70%

THE SESSION

Stocks slipped on Wednesday as the Federal Reserve's September minutes reinforced the case for further tightening. The S&P 500 fell 0.23% to 7,801, retreating from Tuesday's close above 7,800, while the Nasdaq lost 0.22% to 27,539 and the Dow 0.66% to 51,180; the VIX edged up to 15.08. The minutes showed most participants judged another increase in the policy rate likely appropriate by year-end, without indicating timing, following the committee's unanimous 25-basis-point increase in September. The 10-year Treasury yield rose to about 5.36% intraday before easing to 5.28%, against Tuesday's official 5.27%, and Brent held near \$101 a barrel as attacks near the Strait of Hormuz renewed supply concerns. The Federal Trade Commission and the Department of Agriculture opened a request for public comment on agricultural equipment

markets, and equipment makers fell, with Caterpillar down 5.75%. Bitcoin slid below \$84,000 as leveraged positions were unwound, with IBIT down 2.64% and ETHA 4.58%.

The Dividend Strategy fell 1.01%, behind DVY's 0.42% by 0.59 point and SPY's 0.24% by 0.77 point, with four of twenty-five holdings higher. Caterpillar was the largest drag, falling 5.75% to \$813.83 and subtracting about 0.15 point as the agricultural-equipment inquiry weighed on the group. Qualcomm fell 2.19% and NatWest Group 2.38%, subtracting about 0.10 and 0.09 point, neither on a company-specific catalyst. Constellation Energy edged back 0.27% to \$299.59 after Tuesday's 12.25% gain, while SS&C Technologies rose 0.91% and ADP 0.63%.

*Higher-for-longer rates tend to test valuations before they test earnings power.
Businesses with contracted revenue and strong balance sheets can be underwritten
through that rotation. **Think Like an Owner.***

The Growth Portfolio fell 0.97% while IUSG fell 0.24%, behind by 0.73 point, with three of twenty-five holdings higher. Vistra was the only material offset, rising 3.88% to \$166.72 and adding about 0.22 point, extending Tuesday's 10.77% advance. Agnico Eagle was the largest drag, falling 3.03% to \$180.39 and subtracting about 0.18 point on a day gold fell 1.41%. MARA fell 5.56% and Hut 8 3.17%, subtracting

about 0.14 and 0.08 point as bitcoin declined, and Robinhood fell 2.22%. On the year, the Dividend Strategy stands at +17.14% against DVY's +11.20%, a +5.94-point spread, with SPY at +14.87%; the Growth Portfolio stands at +24.73% against IUSG's +18.70%, a +6.03-point spread.

FCI HOLDINGS • NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

VST +3.88%

GROWTH

Closed at \$166.72, extending Tuesday's 10.77% advance; the Growth Portfolio's largest contributor.

CNX +1.96%

GROWTH

Rose to \$33.89 without a company-specific catalyst.

DECLINERS

CAT -5.75%

DIVIDEND

Fell to \$813.83 as agricultural-equipment makers declined on the FTC and USDA request for comment.

MARA -5.56%

GROWTH

Fell to \$10.36 as bitcoin slid below \$84,000.

SSNC +0.91%

DIVIDEND

Rose to \$78.70 without a company-specific catalyst.

ADP +0.63%

DIVIDEND

Rose to \$264.00 without a company-specific catalyst.

NXPI -3.75%

GROWTH

Fell to \$235.22 without a company-specific catalyst.

HUT -3.17%

GROWTH

Fell to \$89.30 as bitcoin declined.

YEAR-TO-DATE STANDING

DIVIDEND STRATEGY

+17.14%

vs DVY +11.20% / SPY +14.87%

Spread vs DVY +5.94 pts

GROWTH PORTFOLIO

+24.73%

vs IUSG +18.70%

Spread vs IUSG +6.03 pts

SOURCES

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